

THE HOPECORE PROJECT

Free Editing Software Guide

Video & Photo Editors + Browser Extensions — 2026

VIDEO EDITING — Fully Free (No Limits)

DaVinci Resolve

100% Free

Hollywood-grade editor. Color grading, VFX, audio. No watermarks, no time limits.

Windows Mac Linux

OpenShot

Open Source

Beginner-friendly open-source editor with simple timeline and transitions. No watermarks.

Windows Mac Linux

Kdenlive

Open Source

Powerful open-source multi-track editor with effects and proxy editing.

Windows Mac Linux

Shotcut

Open Source

Cross-platform with 4K support, 360 video, and a huge filter collection.

Windows Mac Linux

iMovie

100% Free

Apple's polished beginner editor. Full features, no watermarks pre-installed on Mac.

Mac iOS

Blender (Video Editor)

Open Source

Best known for 3D, but includes a fully capable video sequence editor.

Windows Mac Linux

LosslessCut

Open Source

Fast, lossless video cutter/trimmer. No re-encoding. Ideal for splitting large files.

Windows Mac Linux

VirtualDub2

Open Source

Lightweight video capture and processing. Great for batch processing and filters.

Windows

VIDEO EDITING — Free with Limits

CapCut

Free + Limits

AI-powered editor. Auto-captions, templates, filters. Best for TikTok/Reels/Shorts.

Windows Mac iOS Android Browser

Clipchamp

Free + Limits

Browser-based editor built into Windows 11. Simple timeline, stock assets.

Windows Browser

Adobe Express

Free + Limits

Quick social video creation with templates and basic editing.

Browser iOS Android

Canva Video

Free + Limits

Drag-and-drop social video editor. Many AI/premium assets locked behind Pro.

Browser iOS Android

Kapwing

Free + Limits

Browser-based collaborative editor. Free tier adds a watermark on exports.

Browser

InVideo

Free + Limits

AI-assisted marketing video creator. Free plan has watermark and limited exports.

Browser

Lightworks

Free + Limits

Professional NLE used in Hollywood. Free version limits export to 720p H.264.

Windows Mac Linux

VSDC Free Video Editor

Free + Limits

Non-linear editor with motion tracking. Some tools in paid version only.

Windows

PHOTO EDITING — Fully Free (No Limits)

GIMP

Open Source

The #1 free Photoshop alternative. Layers, masks, curves, brushes, clone stamp.

Windows Mac Linux

Darktable

Open Source

Free Lightroom alternative. RAW processing, non-destructive edits, library management.

Windows Mac Linux

RawTherapee

Open Source

Powerful RAW processor with advanced color tools, lens correction, noise reduction.

Windows Mac Linux

Paint.NET

Free

Lightweight yet capable with layers, effects, and a large plugin ecosystem.

Windows

Krita

Open Source

Designed for digital painting. Rich brushes, layer modes, HDR support.

Windows Mac Linux

Snapseed

Free

Google's mobile editor. Non-destructive stacks, selective edits, healing tool.

iOS Android

Photopea

Free (Browser)

Full browser-based editor. Opens PSD, AI, XCF, Sketch files. Near-full Photoshop UI.

Browser

Pixlr E / Pixlr X

Free (Browser)

Two browser editors — E for advanced (layers, liquify), X for quick edits with AI.

Browser

PHOTO EDITING — Free with Limits

Canva (Photo)

Free + Limits

AI Magic Edit, Magic Eraser, background removal. Most AI tools require Canva Pro.

Browser iOS Android

Adobe Lightroom Mobile

Free + Limits

Solid editing and presets on mobile. Cloud sync and advanced tools need subscription.

iOS Android

PhotoDirector

Free + Limits

AI Object Removal, Background Replacement, layer editing. Stock libraries locked.

Windows Mac iOS Android

Fotor

Free + Limits

One-click enhancements, collage maker, AI retouching. AI features need Pro credits.

Browser Windows Mac

Remove.bg

Free + Limits

AI background remover. Free plan outputs lower-res images; HD requires credits.

Browser

VSCO

Free + Limits

Film-like presets and editing. Many presets locked to VSCO membership.

iOS Android

BROWSER EXTENSIONS — Video Enhancers

Enhancer for YouTube

Free

Auto-highest-resolution, ad control, custom speed, cinema mode, equalizer for YouTube.

Chrome Firefox

Video Enhancer – Color Grading

Free

Real-time brightness, contrast, saturation, gamma, sharpness on any streaming video.

Chrome

Return YouTube Dislike

Free

Restores dislike counts and adds playback quality improvements.

Chrome Firefox

BROWSER EXTENSIONS — Photo & Image Tools

Eye Dropper

Free

Pick any color from any webpage. Essential for designers working in-browser.

Chrome Firefox

Image Downloader

Free

Bulk-download all images on a page. Useful for collecting photos for editing.

Chrome Firefox

Imagus

Free

Hover over any thumbnail to zoom in full-size instantly, across nearly every website.

Chrome Firefox

Photopea (PWA)

Free

Full Photoshop-like editor as a pinned browser tab — no install needed.

Chrome Edge Firefox

Remove Background Ext.

Free + Limits

One-click AI background removal directly from the browser context menu.

Chrome

Green badges = fully free / open source. Orange badges = free plan with feature or export restrictions. Platforms shown are indicative.